



FLIP THROUGH BEFORE YOU DOWNLOAD

How Do You Know It Works?

Three real pages, straight off the shipping files, plus everything the full download includes.



Six checks, and they cover almost everything

These are not six checks about *your* tool. They are the six **shapes** of thing that break, and almost every real bug in a small classroom tool is one of them.

#	The check	What it catches
1	The ordinary case. One normal thing, done the normal way.	That it works at all. Run it first and never skip it.
2	The empty case. No names in the list, no questions typed, nothing chosen.	The crash on a Monday morning before you have put anything in.
3	The last one. The final item, the last seat, the thirtieth student.	Counting that is off by one, which is the single most common bug there is.
4	The duplicate. The same name twice, the same answer twice.	Two children called Jack. It will happen in September.
5	The reload. Close it, open it again, and look.	A tool that forgets. The difference between an app and a picture.
6	The refusal. Ask it to do something it should not allow.	The next page is about this one, because it is the one everybody skips.

SNEAK PEEK · 5 pages

Make each one a sentence, not a category

"The empty case" is a reminder. "Open it with no students in the list and press Shuffle — it should say the list is empty, not freeze" is a check. The difference is that the second one has an answer, so somebody else could run it, and so could you in March when you have forgotten everything.

Write what should happen, not just what to do. A check with no expected result is a thing you look at and then decide you are happy with.

Six is the number for a reason

Long enough to catch the shapes above. Short enough that you will actually run it after a change you think is trivial, which is exactly when it earns its keep. A list of twenty gets run once and then admired.

Test the refusals, not the successes

Everybody checks that the thing works. **Almost nobody checks that it stops.** And the refusals are what you need in front of a class, because that is where the embarrassment lives.

What a refusal looks like in a classroom tool

Selling the last one. Stock reaches zero. Does the next tap say "sold out" or does it quietly sell a thing you do not have?

Booking a taken slot. Does it say so, or does it look like it worked?

Deleting something that matters. Does it ask first? Does it refuse outright? **"It just did it" is an answer you only get once.**

And the refusal that is really a message

A tool that cannot do what you asked should **say which thing it could not do and why.** "Error" is not a refusal, it is a shrug. When AI writes you an error message, that message is a feature it wrote without being asked to think about — read it, and make it say something a tired adult can act on.

Write the check before you type

This is the habit that costs nothing and changes everything, and it is about order rather than effort.

1 Decide what should be true afterward

One sentence, written down, **before** you type the prompt. "After this, booking a taken slot should say which slot and offer the next free one."

2 Then prompt

Ask for the change. Let it do whatever it does.

3 Then run the whole list, not just the new bit

All six, every time. **The new thing usually works;** it checks two and five that have quietly stopped working, and you would never have looked.

Why the order matters more than it sounds.

If you decide what "worked" means *after* you see the result, you are not checking it. **You are being persuaded by it,** and a confident reply is very persuasive at half past four.

SNEAK PEEK · 5 pages

A six-line list for a classroom store, and what it caught

A small tool that sells class-money items to students: a shelf, a price, a stock count, a running total. Here is the whole list, in the form a sentence with an expected result.

THE LIST, ON ONE STICKY NOTE

- 1 Sell one sticker. Total goes up by the sticker price, stock drops by one.
- 2 Open with an empty shelf. It says there is nothing to sell.
It does not show a blank screen.
- 3 Sell the last eraser. Stock shows zero.
- 4 Sell a second last eraser. It refuses and says sold out.
- 5 Add two items both called "pencil". Both still sell separately.
- 6 Close the tab, reopen. Shelf, stock and total are all still there.

What it caught, and none of these were visible by clicking around

Check 4. The last item sold, and then sold again, and the stock went to minus. The screen looked completely normal.

Check 6. A later change moved where the total is. The total stopped surviving a reload while everything else did. Nothing about that change looked weird, was near the total.

Check 2. An empty shelf shows a blank white page, which is the version a teacher sees first, on the morning they open it before putting anything in. The worst possible first impression, and the easiest to miss, because you never open your own tool empty after the first day.

SNEAK PEEK · 5 pages

Three bugs, six lines, about four minutes a run

That is the entire argument. It is not thorough and it is not meant to be. It is the cheapest thing that stops you finding out in front of a class.



WHAT IS INSIDE

How Do You Know It Works?

- ✓ Six checks that fit on one sticky note
- ✓ The empty case, the last one, the duplicate, the reload
- ✓ Test the refusals, not the successes
- ✓ Write the check before you prompt, and why order matters
- ✓ A worked list for a real tool, and the three bugs it caught
- ✓ A fill-in page, so you leave with your own six

Running it with your whole staff? Additional teacher licenses are just \$0, and we accept purchase orders through TpT for Schools.

